

Feelzlike App — Comprehensive Review Report

Date: May 8, 2026

URL: <https://feel-zlike-weather-app-1.replit.app/>

Version: v0.3 · Feelzlike

Reviewer: AI QA Agent

1. OVERVIEW

Feelzlike is a "resort town mountain weather" Progressive Web App (PWA) targeting people staying in base towns near skiresorts — particularly the Snowy Mountains, NSW, Australia and Yamanouchi Town, Nagano, Japan. It aggregates weather, road conditions, transport, accommodation, and dining information into a single focused experience for the "should I head up the mountain today?" use case.

The tagline: *"Stop guessing what it feelzlike in the mountains today."*

2. FIRST IMPRESSIONS

Visual Design

- **Color scheme:** Clean white background with blue accent tones (#0066CC-range), green status badges, and subtle grey text. The claimed "finance app" aesthetic is mostly accurate — minimal, data-forward, and professional.
- **Logo:** Strong, distinctive "feelZlike" wordmark with a stylised Z/mountain graphic. Well-executed.
- **Typography:** Clean sans-serif, good hierarchy with uppercase section labels and large bold temperature readouts. Very readable.
- **Layout:** Centered single-column homepage with two region cards below a prominent search bar. Clean and unfussy.
- **Status indicators:** Green "LIVE" dot indicator top-right on detail pages; green/winter badges on sidebar. These are confidence-building signals.
- **Sidebar navigation:** On detail pages, a fixed left sidebar (~240px) with icon+text nav items. Clean and well-organised.
- **Overall impression:** Polished, well above typical early-stage apps. The aesthetic is genuinely good.

Loading

- Homepage loads fast.
- The Japan (Yamanouchi) region initially showed a brief loading state on first visit (temperature card showed "Loading..." with three dots). This resolved within 2-3 seconds.
- The "updated just now" and "next refresh in X min" counters are present and informative.

3. INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

Homepage

- Logo + tagline + hero text
- Status bar: "2 Regions Live · 7 official sources · refreshed every 15 min · updated 3 min ago"
- Search bar: "Search a mountain region..."
- Two region cards: Snowy Mountains (NSW, AU) and Yamanouchi Town (Nagano, JP)
- Footer: The Digest (newsletter), Browse links, About, Privacy, Copyright

Region Detail Page (e.g. /snowy-mountains/jindabyne)

Left sidebar navigation:

1. Sources
2. Town switcher dropdown (Jindabyne / Berridale / Cooma for Snowy Mtns)
3. Today (hub page)
4. Weather forecast
5. Roads & cams
6. Transport
7. Stay
8. Eat
9. Explore
10. Alerts (lock icon — premium)

Top-level season toggle: WINTER / GREEN (summer)

URL structure:

- / — homepage
- /snowy-mountains/jindabyne — today hub
- /snowy-mountains/jindabyne/weather — weather forecast
- /snowy-mountains/jindabyne/roads — road conditions & cams
- /snowy-mountains/jindabyne/transport — transport

- /snowy-mountains/jindabyne/stay — accommodation
- /snowy-mountains/jindabyne/eat — restaurants
- /snowy-mountains/jindabyne/explore — tourism links
- /snowy-mountains/alerts — powder alerts
- /snowy-mountains/sources — data attribution
- /snowy-mountains/mountain/perisher — individual resort detail
- /yamanouchi/yudanaka — Japan hub (same structure)

4. FEATURE TESTING RESULTS

4.1 Live Road Intelligence ✓ (AU) / △ (JP)

Australia (Snowy Mountains):

- 4 roads listed: Kosciuszko Road (Jindabyne→Perisher Valley), Alpine Way (Jindabyne→Thredbo), Kosciuszko Road (Perisher→Charlotte's Pass), Barry Way (Jindabyne→Khancoban)
- Each road shows: direction, status badge (OPEN/CAUTION), plain-English description of conditions, link to Live Traffic NSW source
- Status badges working: OPEN (green), CAUTION (yellow) visible
- Road descriptions mention chains, snow, conditions accurately
- Source attribution: "Live Traffic NSW" shown as data source ✓
- Roadside Cams: 3 live cam images shown from Live Traffic NSW — actual photos of road surfaces (Kosciuszko Rd, Alpine Way junction, Wilsons Valley). Images appear genuine and timestamped by source.
- "All road cams" link present

Japan (Yamanouchi):

- Shows "Live road data coming soon" placeholder
- Appropriately honest — links to JARTIC (Japan Road Traffic Information Center) as fallback
- Roadside cams: Links to official road camera map (external) — no embedded cam images yet
- "No timestamp" shown on this page — minor issue

4.2 Mountain Data ✓

Snowy Mountains — Perisher:

- Header: BOM LIVE · PERISHER VALLEY · ELEV 1720M · UPDATED JUST NOW ✓
- Snow depth: 0 cm (it's currently early May, pre-season — accurate for now)

- Snow next 24h: 0.0 cm
- Wind: 9 km/h SW with gusts 15 km/h
- Lift status: Shows 5 named chairlifts (Village 8 Express, Front Valley Quad, Mt Perisher Double, Interceptor, Blue Cow Terminal) — all "Closed" (pre-season, accurate)
- Lifts Open: 0/11 · Runs Open: 0/100
- 48-hour hourly forecast with temperature + wind data
- Issue: Temperature in header showed "UNKNOWN · FEELZLIKE -2°" — the station name "UNKNOWN" appears instead of a weather station name. This is a data labeling bug.

Japan — Multiple Resorts:

- 5 mountains listed: Maruike, Hoppo Bunadaira, Higashidateyama, Nishidateyama, Takamagahara — all with temperature and travel time

4.3 Weather Forecast ✓

- Current conditions tile: temperature, cloud icon, description
- Current metrics: Wind, Gusts, Humidity, Pressure, Visibility, UV — all populated
- Today summary: High/Low, Sunrise/Sunset, Rain Chance, Snow
- 24-hour hourly chart with icons and temperatures ✓
- 7-day forecast with daily tiles ✓
- Live rain + cloud radar map embedded (appears to be Rainviewer) with toggle for Overall/Clouds/Rain overlays ✓
- Issue: "No timestamp" shown on Jindabyne weather forecast page — despite the page having live data. Inconsistency with other pages that show "Updated just now."

4.4 Dynamic Seasons ✓

- WINTER / GREEN toggle visible in sidebar
- Currently showing WINTER mode
- Season-appropriate content: lift status, chains warnings, snow depths all winter-relevant
- No summer-specific content visible (presumably that's "GREEN" mode)

4.5 "Feelzlike" Edge — Timestamps & Freshness ✓/⚠

- Homepage: "refreshed every 15 min · updated 3 min ago" ✓
- Region hub pages: "Updated just now · Next in 10 min · Open-Meteo + BOM" ✓
- Weather forecast page: "No timestamp" ✗
- Japan roads page: "No timestamp" ✗
- Japan Yudanaka hub: Initially "No timestamp" then loaded to show "Updated just now"

4.6 Transport ✓

- Cooma Coaches featured as main local operator with phone number, website, and route description
- Daily scheduled service info with timetable link
- Other operators listed: NSW Trainlink Xplorer, SnoExpress
- Clean, functional

4.7 Stay ✓

- "Live Search" badge
- Local provider: Snowy Mountains Accommodation (independent regional site)
- 6 booking platforms pre-linked: [Booking.com](#), Airbnb, Agoda, [Trip.com](#), [Hotels.com](#), Expedia
- Honest affiliate disclosure: "Feelzlike may earn a commission from bookings made through these links - it never costs you extra."
- Well executed

4.8 Eat ✓

- Links to Google Maps categories: Restaurants, Cafes, Pubs & bars, Takeaway, Supermarkets
- One-tap "Open Jindabyne on Google Maps" CTA
- Pragmatic and useful

4.9 Powder Alerts ✓

- Email subscription form
- Region selector: Snowy Mountains (AU) / Yamanouchi (JP)
- Threshold slider: 5cm–50cm (default 15cm)
- Look-ahead window: Next 24hr / 48hr / 72hr
- Disclaimer: "Real-time storm tracking is coming soon — for now, subscribe and we'll email you when forecast models show your threshold being met"
- Privacy checkbox + policy link
- Subscribe button (functional-looking, not tested to submit)

4.10 Sources / Attribution ✓

- Dedicated /sources page with well-organised categories:
 - Live observations: Bureau of Meteorology
 - Roads & transport: Transport for NSW – Live Traffic, Cooma Coaches, NSW Trainlink
 - Resorts & lifts: Thredbo, Perisher, Charlotte's Pass, Selwyn Snow Resort

- Each source has an external link icon

4.11 Explore ✓

- Tourism links: Snowy Mountains – Destination NSW, Visit NSW, Snowy Valleys Council
- National Parks: Kosciuszko National Park (NPWS)
- Resorts: Perisher, Thredbo, Selwyn, Charlotte's Pass

5. BUGS & ISSUES (PRIORITISED)

☒ CRITICAL

C1: "Start Free Trial" button is non-functional

- On the Perisher mountain detail page, the "Extended outlook 7/14/21 day", "Detailed conditions", and "Powder & weather alerts" premium upsell cards all have "Start free trial" buttons that navigate to # (the page anchor), effectively doing nothing.
- This is the primary monetisation CTA on the site. It is completely broken.
- Affected URL: `/snowy-mountains/mountain/perisher`
- Impact: Any user interested in upgrading gets a dead link. Revenue lost.

C2: "UNKNOWN" weather station label on Perisher mountain page

- The temperature header on the Perisher page shows: "UNKNOWN · FEELZLIKE -2°"
- "UNKNOWN" should be the name of the weather station (e.g. "Perisher Valley AWS" or similar).
- This looks broken/unprofessional and undermines data trust.
- Affected URL: `/snowy-mountains/mountain/perisher`

☒ MAJOR

M1: "No timestamp" on Weather Forecast page

- The Jindabyne weather forecast page (`/snowy-mountains/jindabyne/weather`) shows "No timestamp" next to the clock icon.
- For a "live data you can trust" app, missing timestamps on a primary page is a significant credibility gap.
- Inconsistent with other pages that correctly show "Updated just now."

M2: "No timestamp" on Japan Roads page

- `/yamanouchi/yudanaka/roads` shows "No timestamp" — while understandable given it's a "coming soon" page, the clock icon with no value looks like a bug rather than intentional.
- Recommendation: Either remove the clock icon or replace with "Coming soon" text.

M3: Japan Roads — "Live road data coming soon" gap

- The Japan roads page has no live road data — just a link to JARTIC.
- This is honestly disclosed but represents a significant feature gap for Japanese users of what is marketed as a "live roads" app.
- Users in Japan have no road condition information.

M4: Search is limited to 2 region cards only

- The homepage search bar filters the two visible region cards only. Typing "Perisher" shows the Snowy Mountains card; typing "Japan" shows the Yamanouchi card.
- There is no ability to search for individual mountains, resorts, or specific towns (e.g., "Thredbo", "Cooma", "Berridale").
- This is misleading given the "Search a mountain region..." placeholder suggests broader search capability.
- A user landing on the homepage looking for "Thredbo" specifically would be confused.

M5: No no-data state for pre-season lifts — context unclear

- Perisher shows 0/11 lifts, 0/100 runs as "Closed" with no explanation that it's pre-season (season opens June/July).
- A first-time user in early May might think the resort is just "closed today" rather than understanding it's pre-season. A simple "Season opens ~June 2026" note would reduce confusion.

☒ MINOR

m1: "No timestamp" flash on Japan Yudanaka hub page initial load

- On first navigation, the page briefly shows "No timestamp" before data loads. Should show a loading skeleton or spinner instead.

m2: Footer mentions BOM as source but Yamanouchi data uses Open-Meteo + BOM

- The Japan region footer/source shows "Open-Meteo + BOM" — BOM is the Australian Bureau of Meteorology. This doesn't make sense for Japan. BOM should not be credited for Japanese weather data. This is likely a data source label copy-paste error.

m3: Season indicator says "GREEN" in sidebar but current season is WINTER

- The sidebar shows both "❄ WINTER" and "☒ GREEN" badges side by side. It's unclear if GREEN means "currently in season / open for business" or if it's the season toggle for summer mode. The UI is ambiguous.
- If GREEN means "resort open status," it's misleading in May when resorts are pre-season (all lifts closed, yet the badge is green).

m4: Selwyn Snow Resort shown on Berridale page, but not listed as a source

- Selwyn Snow Resort appears in Berridale's mountain list and in the Explore links but is NOT listed in the Sources > Resorts & lifts section, which only shows Thredbo, Perisher, Charlotte's Pass, and Selwyn Snow Resort (wait — it IS there). Verified OK.

m5: Japan language switcher (EN/日/語) in sidebar

- A language toggle appears in the Japan region sidebar. The EN option appears clickable. No Japanese translation was tested but this is a positive feature for the target Japanese market.

m6: "The Digest" newsletter in footer says "every fortnight" — oddly infrequent

- For a live weather/conditions app, a bi-weekly newsletter seems out of step with the real-time positioning. Consider at least weekly.

m7: Explore page description says "onsen links" for Snowy Mountains

- /snowy-mountains/jindabyne/explore description: "Official tourism, attraction, resort and onsen links for Snowy Mountains."
- There are no onsens in the Snowy Mountains. This is a copy-paste from the Japan region template. Minor content error.

m8: Charlotte's Pass listed as town AND resort inconsistently

- Charlotte's Pass appears as a mountain resort on the "Weather in Mountains" card, but it's a village/resort, not a base town. This is fine, but the travel time says "~39 min" from Jindabyne, which is accurate.

m9: Powder Alerts lock icon on Alerts sidebar item

- Alerts shows a padlock icon suggesting it's premium/locked, but clicking it loads a free sign-up form with no paywall. The lock icon may confuse users into thinking they can't access alerts.

6. UX CRITIQUE

6.1 Value Proposition

✓ Strong above-the-fold messaging. "Stop guessing what it feelzlike in the mountains today" + sub-description clearly explains the app. The status bar ("2 regions live, 7 sources, refreshed every 15 min, updated 3 min ago") immediately establishes credibility.

6.2 User Journey

✓ Region cards → Town hub → specific data is a clear and logical flow. First-time users can navigate intuitively.

△ However: There is no explicit onboarding or "start here" instruction. A first-time visitor from search might not know which town to pick (Jindabyne vs Berridale vs Cooma). A brief tooltip or short description on first visit would help.

6.3 Primary CTA / "Should I Go?" Decision

△ The core decision ("should I go up today?") is not surfaced as a single answer. The Today hub page shows current town temp + nearby mountain temps + feature category links. But there's no "GO / WAIT / NO" decision summary. The closest is the road status badges (OPEN/CAUTION/CLOSED) and snow depth, but they require the user to synthesize the data themselves.

Suggestion: A "Today Summary" card on the hub page: e.g. "Roads: OPEN · Mountain: 2°C clear · Snow: 0cm · Lifts: 0/11 · Verdict: Roads are fine but no skiing today."

6.4 Search Functionality

△ **Limited.** Search only filters the 2 region cards, not individual towns/resorts. No autocomplete, no suggestion dropdown. With only 2 regions currently, this is fine for now, but won't scale.

6.5 Personalization / Settings

✗ **None.** No ability to set a home region, preferred temperature unit (Celsius shown, no Fahrenheit toggle), or preferred resort. The star/bookmark icon on homepage region cards suggests saving is possible but clicking it had no visible effect.

6.6 Mobile Responsiveness

Could not test directly by resizing viewport in cloud browser, but the app is built as a PWA with a "Add to Home Screen" prompt and mobile-appropriate tap targets. The sidebar-based navigation on detail pages (240px wide) would consume most of a 375px mobile viewport, leaving only 135px for content — this is likely a significant mobile layout issue.

Recommendation: Test on actual mobile device. The sidebar likely needs to collapse to a hamburger menu on mobile.

6.7 Premium / Monetization UX

☒ **Critical gap.** The premium upsell for "Extended outlook 7/14/21 day", "Detailed conditions", and "Powder & weather alerts" shows blurred/locked content with "Start free trial" buttons — but these buttons link to # and do nothing. This is the app's monetization engine and it's completely non-functional.

Monthly subscription model with "seasonal pass coming soon" text is noted — suggesting the billing system isn't built yet.

6.8 Accessibility

- No alt text testing done (no dev tools access), but icon-heavy navigation without text labels in some areas could be an issue
- Font sizes appear reasonable at desktop resolution

- Color contrast of grey text on white backgrounds in some metadata areas (e.g., "19 km · ~29 min · clear sky") may not meet WCAG AA contrast requirements

7. CONTENT QUALITY

Positives:

- Clear, confident marketing copy — "mountain weather you can trust"
- Road descriptions are genuinely helpful: "Chains may be required during and after snowfall"
- Safety section on resort pages (NSW back-country bulletin, avalanche awareness, ski patrol) — excellent
- Source page is well-written with clear rationale for multi-model approach

Issues:

- "onsen links" on Snowy Mountains Explore page — Japanese content leaked into Australian page (copy-paste error)
- "UNKNOWN" weather station label — needs fixing
- "No timestamp" text appearing in multiple places — looks broken, not intentional
- The "Feelzlike X°" notation (e.g. "Feelzlike 0°") — it's unclear this is the "feels like" temperature. Consider changing to "Feels like 0°" for clarity.

8. PERFORMANCE OBSERVATIONS

- Initial load: Fast (under 3 seconds estimated)
- Japan region had ~2 second data load delay on first navigation
- Road cam images on the NSW page loaded quickly and appeared genuine/current
- The rain radar map (Rainviewer integration) loaded well
- No obvious jank or layout shifts observed
- App is served from Replit hosting — production deployment would benefit from a CDN

9. REGION & COVERAGE

Australia: Snowy Mountains, NSW — covering:

- Base towns: Jindabyne, Berridale, Cooma
- Resorts: Perisher, Thredbo, Charlotte's Pass, Selwyn Snow Resort
- Word "bitumen" appears in road descriptions — confirming AU localisation ✓

Japan: Yamanouchi Town, Nagano Prefecture — covering:

- Base towns: Yudanaka, Shibu Onsen, Yomase

- Mountains: Maruike, Hoppo Bunadaira, Higashidateyama, Nishidateyama, Takamagahara, Shiga Kogen, X-Jam, Ryuoo (from homepage card)

The focus on these two regions makes sense for an MVP, though the marketing doesn't yet call this out as a limitation.

10. SUMMARY

What Works Well ✓

1. Excellent visual design — clean, professional, and appropriate for the use case
2. Live road conditions (NSW) — real data, real cams, clear status badges, source attribution
3. Weather data is real and current — BOM + Open-Meteo integration works
4. Multiple mountain resorts per region — gives meaningful comparative data
5. Lift status with named chairlifts — genuinely useful
6. Transport page — well curated with phone numbers and links
7. Stay page — honest affiliate disclosure, good platform coverage
8. Data source attribution — dedicated sources page builds trust
9. PWA features — install prompt, mobile-ready architecture
10. Powder Alerts form — well designed with threshold and window controls
11. Safety section on resort pages — shows care for users
12. Season toggle (WINTER/GREEN) — shows forward thinking for year-round use

Prioritised Issues

☒ Critical (Fix Immediately)

#	Issue	Location
C1	"Start free trial" buttons link to # and do nothing	/snowy-mountains/mountain/perisher
C2	Weather station name shows "UNKNOWN" instead of real name	Perisher mountain header

☒ Major (Fix Before Marketing)

#	Issue	Location
M1	"No timestamp" on weather forecast page	/snowy-mountains/jindabyne/weather
M2	"No timestamp" on Japan roads page	/yamanouchi/yudanaka/roads
M3	No live road data for Japan at all	Roads section
M4	Search only filters 2 cards — misleading placeholder	Homepage

#	Issue	Location
M5	No pre-season context for closed lifts	Perisher mountain page

☒ Minor (Polish Pass)

#	Issue	Location
m1	Timestamp flash on Japan hub load	Yudanaka hub
m2	BOM credited as Japan data source	Yudanaka pages
m3	GREEN badge ambiguous (open/season?)	All sidebar views
m6	"Fortnightly digest" feels slow for live app	Footer
m7	"onsen links" copy on Snowy Mountains Explore page	/snowy-mountains/jindabyne/explore
m9	Alerts padlock icon misleads about paywall	Sidebar

11. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR ENHANCEMENT

High Priority

1. Fix "Start free trial" CTA — wire up to an actual sign-up/payment flow, even just a "join waitlist" email capture for now
2. Fix "UNKNOWN" station label — replace with actual station name from data source
3. Fix timestamp propagation — ensure all pages show a consistent "Updated X min ago" timestamp
4. Add a "Go/Wait" decision summary to the Today hub page — this is the core value prop; surface a simple traffic-light verdict
5. Mobile sidebar — implement collapsible hamburger menu for ≤ 768 px viewports

Medium Priority

6. Search autocomplete — add dropdown suggestions for towns and resorts, not just region filtering
7. Pre-season/out-of-season context — show "Season opens ~June 2026" when all lifts are closed in May
8. Bookmark/favourite region — the star icon implies this; implement local storage persistence
9. Japan road data — prioritise live road conditions integration for JARTIC as the single biggest feature gap for JP users
10. "Feels like" label clarity — "Feelzlike 0°" is clever but could confuse; ensure it's labelled clearly

Lower Priority

11. Content audit for copy-paste errors — "onsen" on Snowy Mountains; BOM on Japan
12. Weather station name in Perisher header
13. "Fortnightly" digest → consider weekly or event-triggered (powder events)
14. Accessibility audit — alt text, contrast ratios on metadata text
15. Performance on Replit — consider CDN + caching for production
16. User settings/preferences — temperature units (C/F), home region, notification preferences

Report generated by AI QA Review Agent — May 8, 2026